

Chapter 66-6

Qiu Zimin's entire heart was now fixated on her own daughter. She couldn't be bothered to wrangle with Liang Shi anymore. Seeing her only filled her with intense disgust.

"But I still have things to talk about with you." Liang Shi looked at her. "For instance—Yunfeng Mountain?"

She said word by word: "Or—Yang Jiani? Or again—Zhou Yi'an?"

Qiu Zimin coldly denied: "What are you talking about? I don't understand."

"Really?" Liang Shi said: "Like you, I don't want to make things difficult for Elder Brother and Second Brother either."

"Those are not your brothers!" Qiu Zimin said sternly: "Who knows where you came from, you bastard. Don't try to claim my sons."

"Fine." Liang Shi didn't argue with her, only telling her: "Then let's close the door and talk. Otherwise, your sons might see your hysterical appearance."

Qiu Zimin glared at her, then stepped aside halfway, taking a deep breath and saying: "Say whatever you want to say, then get lost quickly. I have nothing to say to you."

Liang Shi's phone in her pocket was still lit, the screen displaying: Recording 00:04:20.

She didn't sit down, just stood there, then quietly looked at Qiu Zimin, looking until Qiu Zimin felt irritated. "If you have nothing to say, then get out. I don't want to see you."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together. After a long while, she finally spoke: "Why do you hate me so much?"

Yes.

Hate.

Ten thousand times heavier than dislike.

Qiu Zimin closed her eyes. "Whenever I think of you enjoying wealth and luxury here while my daughter is still suffering somewhere in poverty, I wish I could strangle you."

"But this result wasn't my choice." Liang Shi said: "You could have chosen not to pick me up back then, to let me remain a piece of garbage, rather than picking me up and tormenting me like this."

Qiu Zimin looked at her. "Liang Shi, you've got it wrong, haven't you? I tormented you? I gave you affection, gave you wealth and luxury, and brothers who dote on you so much. Where did I torment you? Now whenever I think of my Nuan Nuan¹, my heart aches to death."

"Then what if your Nuan Nuan was also raised by others the way you raised me?" Liang Shi curved her lips in a smile that carried a hint of coldness. "Like you said, given affection, given wealth and luxury, and given doting brothers. Would you be sad?"

Qiu Zimin's breathing hitched, and she immediately said: "My Nuan Nuan would never be like you—with such a strange and twisted personality, an ungrateful wretch."

"I'm an ungrateful wretch?" Liang Shi raised an eyebrow. "Not accepting your PUA² makes me an ungrateful wretch?"

"Who's PUA-ing you!" Qiu Zimin said sternly: "Don't just learn a internet term and use it indiscriminately! Liang Shi, now you've grown up, your wings have hardened, you can turn your two brothers against me. Do you know what Liang Xinzhou said?"

"I don't really want to know." Liang Shi said.

Even if she knew, it wouldn't change anything, and would only make her feel more guilty.

"You see! You're just heartless." Qiu Zimin accused her from a moral high ground. "Your eldest brother told us not to look for our Nuan Nuan anymore. That's his real sister, and you made him so cold-blooded. What kind of poison did you feed him!"

"Believe it or not, I haven't mentioned a single word to Elder Brother about your biological daughter." Liang Shi remained calm. "I just want to ask you, why do you hate me so much?"

"I don't hate you." Qiu Zimin stubbornly stuck to this statement.

Liang Shi paused before saying: "Then why did you conspire with Daoist Yunyin³, arrange my room like a coffin, and want to use me as a sacrifice? Do you really believe in these things?"

Qiu Zimin frowned, her teeth nearly grinding to pieces, yet she denied: "I sought Daoist Yunyin to cure your illness. Back then you were so sick you couldn't even get out of bed. If it weren't for Daoist Yunyin, you would have died long ago."

"That was just a common cold. Taking medicine or getting an IV would have been fine." Liang Shi said: "Why is it that when Elder Brother, Second Brother, and Wanwan got sick, you called family doctors for them, but when it came to me, you started with feudal superstition?"

"You simply wanted to give me a room like that, didn't you?" Liang Shi analyzed in a low voice. "To crush my spirit, to make me feel I should only live in darkness, to make me feel like I'm a piece of garbage that everyone looks down on, that only you truly care for me, and thereby..."

Before she could finish the second half of the sentence about "better control me," Qiu Zimin interrupted her words. "Yes!"

Qiu Zimin glared at her viciously. "You are a piece of garbage. If I hadn't picked you up, you should be sleeping in garbage every day."

"But you could have chosen not to pick me up." Liang Shi sneered. "You picked me up to compensate for the pain of losing your daughter. My existence, to some extent, brought comfort to your spirit. You should be thanking me, right? But why did you want to drive me insane?"

"You should be a lunatic, an idiot, mentally ill, sent to a mental hospital." Qiu Zimin said: "There's no why."

Liang Shi found this too slow. She couldn't get anything out of her at all, only feeling her negative energy and endless disgust.

So she changed her tactics. "You knew Mrs. Qi had domestic violence tendencies, right?"

Qiu Zimin suddenly paused. She asked warily: "What are you trying to say?"

Liang Shi said: "Mrs. Qi, that is Yang Jiani—you have a good relationship with her? Why did you send me to her house?"

The room suddenly fell silent.

For a while, no one spoke.

After a long time, Qiu Zimin sneered: "Liang Shi, are you planning to dig up old scores now? It seems your memory is quite good—you still remember things from so many years ago."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together: "Some traumas were too severe. They're indeed hard to forget."

"So what?" Qiu Zimin said: "Do you want to settle accounts with me or with Mrs. Qi?"

"The criminal punishment for domestic violence is very light." Liang Shi said: "Besides, it's been so many years. How could there be any sentencing? Even if you took it to court, it wouldn't be accepted."

Qiu Zimin chuckled lightly. "You even looked up the law. Liang Shi, you've asked me so many 'whys,' so let me ask you one too."

She paused, her gaze instantly becoming vicious. "Why haven't you gone insane yet?"

Liang Shi revealed a gentle smile. To Qiu Zimin, this smile was piercingly glaring.

But Liang Shi said: "Perhaps, when you didn't know it, I already did go insane."

The original body had already been driven nearly mad by her.

Self-harm, sex addiction, giving up halfway on seeing a psychologist, bipolar disorder.

Basically ruined.

The current one was a different Liang Shi, one who hoped to seek justice for herself and also for the original body.

Qiu Zimin sneered lightly. "What a pity I couldn't witness your madness with my own eyes."

"That is indeed a pity." Liang Shi agreed with her words, then steered the topic back. "So you knew Yang Jiani was a habitual domestic abuser, right? Sending me there, nominally for discipline, was really just to make me suffer."

Qiu Zimin looked at her. After a moment, she smiled. "Since you've even looked up Mrs. Qi's real name, do you know or not that her daughter is already dead?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, then nodded: "So what?"

"So why would you provoke a lunatic who would personally kill her own daughter?" Qiu Zimin's expression became maniacal in an instant, looking at Liang Shi with bloodthirsty light in her eyes. "I also regret not being like Mrs. Qi and killing you early on!"

Footnotes:

¹ Nuan Nuan (囡囡): An affectionate term for a young daughter, often used in southern Chinese dialects. It literally means "little girl" and conveys endearment.

² PUA: Stands for "Pick-Up Artist" but in modern Chinese internet slang, it refers to psychological manipulation and emotional abuse tactics used to control or gaslight someone in relationships.

³ Daoist Yunyin (雲隱道長): "Daoist" is a title for a Taoist priest or master. "Yunyin" literally means "cloud hidden" or "hidden in clouds." "Daochang" (道長) is a respectful title for a Taoist priest, similar to "reverend" or "master."